Monday Nite Footballers Predictions

By Jim "Grand Dad" Nunnelly
Predicting Since 1970

Super Bowl XXXVII
Oakland Raiders
Versus
Tampa Bay Buccaneers
5:18 p.m., ABC-TV 9

Ike Gardner
Oakland by 6
Good defense overrides good offense; But my 'gut' level pushes me toward Oakland

Paul Booker
Oakland by 14
Raiders will serve up plenty of Brown/Rice

Charles Allen
Oakland by 14
It's Gannon time

Carl Clark (7)
Oakland by 7
Raiders' offense is superior

Lloyd Greenfield
Oakland by 7
Tampa will disintegrate, Oakland will prevail

Ollie Hubbard
Oakland by 3
Power to the Elderly

Jim Nunnelly
Tampa Bay by 6
Bucs have the Gruden edge

Ed West
Oakland by 10
Best quarterback and great receivers

Bubba Cleaver
Oakland by 10
Gannon's cannon

Jon Gray
Oakland by 10
Tim Brown's time

Donna Stewart
THE CALL
Oakland by 7
Intangibles

Tracy Allen
THE CALL
Oakland by 3
Respect your elders (Gannon, Rice, Brown, Woodson, Romanowski)

Chatter, Conversation And Commentary

There are two important similarities to the two teams in the 2003 Super Bowl. First, they both proudly wave Pirates' flags, one calling themselves the Buccaneers and the other known respectfully as the Raiders. Then, too, each share the influence of a common head coach, Jon Gruden. There, the similarities cease. On the other hand, the Raiders sport the NFL's Most Valuable Player in quarterback, Rich Gannon. On the other hand, the Bucs have Warren Sapp, arguably the best defensive lineman to ever play the game in recent times. The Raiders will place their receiving hopes in their Medicare acquisition, Jerry Rice. And the Bucs will put their trust in Deion-like, Keyshawn Johnson. All of this makes for a competitive and entertaining Super Bowl, assuring that each team has a reasonable chance to win. Of course, most Monday Niters believe in Oakland. That's because they are Gannon worshippers, never letting go of the fact that the Chiefs let this rugged individualist star get away. Plus, they feel some faulty pride in that the AFC West produced the most competitive division in football. Nevertheless, the Bucs have a coaching genius in Jon Gruden. And it is my belief that this "coaching factor" is a real key. While some may rightfully argue that the coach will not wear a uniform, leaving player performance as the most important outcome factor on Sunday. But, any respectable football fan, knows that in close games, the coaching effect reigns supreme. Things like clock management, blitz-timing, and playcalling are all decisions directly influenced by the head coaches. So, given that this will be one of the closest Super Bowl games, Jon Gruden becomes the "difference maker" out in San Diego, giving the Bucs the vital edge and their first championship ever.

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